



Sold in a minute

Ticket to Microsoft's annual developers 'Build' conference sold out in just a minute. <http://dgit.in/MSBuildConf>



Other side of development

This year CES saw so many new products, but this booth of Green Electronics was unique. <http://dgit.in/CESGreenEC>

Video Streaming Services



NETFLIX

Price: ₹650 per month
Overall Score: 76.2 / 100

From one of the best to the best. In terms of performance, Netflix lives up to its name. Its smart algorithms are the smartest out there and can assure stutter free streaming on most Internet connections. Yes, on the 2Mbps line, Netflix would often start streaming at SD quality, but it maintained HD longer than others and drops the resolution smartly, so as to avoid buffering. Its launch times were also amongst the lowest, launching movies and TV Shows in a wink, while seeking to various sections of the video typically took 3 seconds.

What made Netflix the best performer though was its video quality. The fact that Netflix retains HD quality longer than others is easy to ascertain, but more importantly, it seems that even when content is compressed to fit network speeds, Netflix yearns to deliver the best possible. Truly unique!

Performance = 76.7

Video load time (wired).....8.6 sec
Video load time (mobile).....4 sec
Stutter free performance.....10/10
CPU usage.....16.2%
RAM usage.....438.1 MB
Video quality.....9.5/10



BIGFLIX

Price: ₹249 per month
Overall Score: 58.4 / 100

Bigflix has been in the video-on-demand business much longer than any of the other services.

While the Bigflix desktop version consumes the least system resources and can seek to various locations of a movie in less than 4 seconds, it's mobile app really needs a lot of work as it's severely below par. On phones, the streaming quality is nowhere close to what Bigflix offers on the desktop, which is what leads to its downfall in our performance tests. The video launch times can go up to 25 seconds and the app often just hangs at certain points, leaving you completely clueless. In addition, the stutter free experience is great on its desktop app but needs some work on mobile.

From an overall performance point of view, Bigflix couldn't really make it with the top dogs.

Performance = 58.3

Video load time (wired).....11.1 sec
Video load time (mobile).....22 sec
Stutter free performance.....10/10
CPU usage.....13.1%
RAM usage.....389.9 MB
Video quality.....5/10



HOTSTAR

Price: Free
Overall Score: 72.9 / 100

Perhaps the most intriguing of all the services we tested was Hotstar. Star India's streaming app allows you to stream all the content available on it for free. In addition, it's really the only one that followed the television model, meaning that Hotstar also has live television features. It's various tie-ups allow you to watch cricket and other sports on it, along with other content.

In terms of the performance, Hotstar can do almost as well as Netflix and Eros Now, but its focus seems to be primarily towards mobile users. While Hotstar offers a pretty seamless experience on the desktop as well, during the course of our tests, twice we experienced very long waiting times on Hotstar for a considerable period.

On mobile though, Hotstar works really well, with impressive launch speeds of up to 7 seconds, while seeking doesn't result in a lot of stutter.

Performance = 69.2

Video load time (wired).....13 sec
Video load time (mobile).....4.6 sec
Stutter free performance.....8.8/10
CPU usage.....13.2%
RAM usage.....406.7 MB
Video quality.....8/10



WYNK MOVIES

Price: ₹38
Overall Score: 52.1 / 100

Airtel's tie-up with Eros Now, Hooq and Sony LIV resulted in Wynk Movies. While it's a streaming service like any other, Wynk Movies differs in the fact that it's available only for mobile users. It's a somewhat surprising move, but Airtel seems to be betting that its users will be viewing content more on mobile and less on desktop.

As far as the streaming quality goes, Wynk can do quite well. It offers a largely stutter free experience and launch times were long, but not too long. The smart algorithms on the app are also quite good at controlling streaming quality, but not quite as seamless on slower connections.

The fact that there is no desktop version to this service means we can't directly compare it to the others in this test, but if you do happen to watch a lot of content on mobile, this is a good performer for sure.

Performance = 51.9

Video load time (wired).....NA
Video load time (mobile).....9 sec
Stutter free performance.....6/10
CPU usage.....NA
RAM usage.....NA
Video quality.....7/10